

AYANA NIWA

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Ph.D. in Engineering / NLP Researcher

@ ayana.niwa.28@gmail.com

Abu Dhabi, UAE

ayaniwa.github.io/

@ayaniwa1213

ayaniwa

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Project Researcher

National Institute of Informatics

Nov. 2025 -

Tokyo, Japan

Visiting Scientist

RIKEN Center for Advanced Intelligence Project (AIP)

May. 2025 -

Tokyo, Japan

Researcher

MBZUAI

Oct. 2024 -

Abu Dhabi, UAE

Research Scientist

Megagon Labs, Recruit Co., Ltd.

Apr. 2023 - Sep. 2024

Tokyo, Japan

- Job Description: dialogue systems, task ambiguity

Researcher

Tokyo Institute of Technology

June 2023 - Sep. 2024

Tokyo, Japan

- Research Theme: Prompt optimization, non-autoregressive generation

JSPS Research Fellow (DC2)

Japan Society for the Promotion of Science

Apr. 2021 - Mar. 2023

Tokyo, Japan

- Research Theme: Structuring templates and acquiring lexical knowledge for text generation

Internship and Outsourced Business

Megagon Labs, Recruit Co., Ltd

June 2019 - Mar. 2023

Tokyo, Japan

- Research Theme: Sentiment analysis

EDUCATION

Tokyo Institute of Technology

Ph.D. Student in Computer Science

Apr. 2020 - Mar. 2023

Tokyo, Japan

Tokyo Institute of Technology

M.S. in Computer Science

Apr. 2018 - Mar. 2020

Tokyo, Japan

Sophia University

B.S. in Science Information

Apr. 2014 - Mar. 2018

Tokyo, Japan

PUBLICATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Journal

- [A. Niwa](#), S. Takase, and N. Okazaki, “Nearest Neighbor Non-autoregressive Text Generation,” *Journal of Information Processing*, vol. 31, pp. 344–352, 2023. DOI: 10.2197/ipsjip.31.344.
- [A. Niwa](#), N. Okazaki, K. Wakimoto, K. Nishiguchi, and M. Mouri, “Construction of a Corpus of Rhetorical Devices in Slogans and Structural Analysis of Antitheses,” *ACM Trans. Asian Low-Resour. Lang. Inf. Process.*, vol. 20, no. 6, 2021, ISSN: 2375-4699. DOI: 10.1145/3465218.

International Conferences

- D. Kuzmin, C. J. G. Zavala, M. A. A. Hakim, T. Hiraoka, M. S. Nwadike, [A. Niwa](#), M. Cognetta, D. Pohl, and K. Inui, “Mitigating the impact of glitch tokens via targeted retokenization,” in *Proceedings of the 5th Asia-Pacific Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: AACL 2026*, 2026, (to appear).
- R. Koike, M. Kaneko, [A. Niwa](#), P. Nakov, and N. Okazaki, “ExaGPT: Example-based machine-generated text detection for human interpretability,” in *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026*, 2026, (to appear).
- M. Ryo, M. Gaku, [A. Niwa](#), K. Masahiro, I. Kentaro, M. Terufumi, K. Yuta, and S. Yasuhiro, “Disentangling the effects of unlearning in measuring parametric faithfulness of chain-of-thought,” in *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 4: Student Research Workshop)*, San Diego, California, United States: Association for Computational Linguistics, 2026.
- M. Kaneko, [A. Niwa](#), and T. Baldwin, “JailNewsBench: Multi-lingual and regional benchmark for fake news generation under jailbreak attacks,” in *The Fourteenth International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2026.
- [A. Niwa](#), M. Kaneko, and K. Inui, “Rectifying belief space via unlearning to harness LLMs’ reasoning,” in *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025*, W. Che, J. Nabende, E. Shutova, and M. T. Pilehvar, Eds., Vienna, Austria: Association for Computational Linguistics, 2025, pp. 25 060–25 075, ISBN: 979-8-89176-256-5. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2025.findings-acl.1285.
- [A. Niwa](#) and H. Iso, “AmbigNLG: Addressing task ambiguity in instruction for NLG,” in *Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*, Y. Al-Onaizan, M. Bansal, and Y.-N. Chen, Eds., Miami, Florida, USA: Association for Computational Linguistics, 2024, pp. 10 733–10 752. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2024.emnlp-main.599.
- M. Kaneko, S. Takase, [A. Niwa](#), and N. Okazaki, “Interpretability for Language Learners Using Example-Based Grammatical Error Correction,” in *Proceedings of the 60th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, S. Muresan, P. Nakov, and A. Villavicencio, Eds., Dublin, Ireland: Association for Computational Linguistics, 2022, pp. 7176–7187. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2022.acl-long.496.
- [A. Niwa](#), K. Nishiguchi, and N. Okazaki, “Predicting Antonyms in Context using BERT,” in *Proceedings of the 14th International Conference on Natural Language Generation*, Aberdeen, Scotland, UK: Association for Computational Linguistics, 2021, pp. 48–54. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2021.inlg-1.6.

Preprint

- T. Shiotani, M. Kaneko, A. Niwa, Y. Maruyama, D. Oba, M. Ohi, and N. Okazaki, *Jubaku: An adversarial benchmark for exposing culturally grounded stereotypes in japanese llms*, 2026. arXiv: 2603.20581 [cs.CL].

Article

- [A. Niwa](#), S. Yokoi, J. Takayama, and I. Saito. (2024). “NLP Colloquium.” [Online]. Available: https://www.jstage.jst.go.jp/article/jnlp/31/1/31_300/_article/-char/en.

Domestic Conferences and Symposiums

- [A. Niwa](#), M. Kaneko, and K. Inui, “Is in-context knowledge integrated consistently into an LLM’s belief system?” In the *32nd Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2026)*, Utsunomiya, Japan, 2026 [**Special Committee Award** 🏆].
- R. Miyazato, [A. Niwa](#), K. Inui, and K. Harada, “Verification of Temporal Reasoning Abilities of Language Models in Nonlinear Narratives,” in the *20th Young Researcher Association for NLP Studies Symposium 2025 (YANS2025)*, Shizuoka, 2025.

- **A. Niwa**, M. Kaneko, and K. Inui, “Rectifying Belief Space via Unlearning to Harness LLMs’ Reasoning,” in *Proceedings of the 39th Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI2025)*, 2025. DOI: 10.11517/pjsai.JSAI2025.0_2Win550 [**JSAI Annual Conference Award** 🏆].
- R. Koike, M. Kaneko, **A. Niwa**, P. Nakov, and N. Okazaki, “Exagpt: Example-based machine-generated text detection for improving interpretability,” in *Proceedings of the 39th Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI2025)*, vol. JSAI2025, 2025, 3Win589–3Win589. DOI: 10.11517/pjsai.JSAI2025.0_3Win589.
- T. Shiotani, M. Kaneko, **A. Niwa**, Y. Maruyama, D. Oba, M. Ohi, and N. Okazaki, “Adversarial benchmark for evaluating stereotypes in Japanese culture,” in *Proceedings of the 39th Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI2025)*, vol. JSAI2025, 2025, 3Win512–3Win512. DOI: 10.11517/pjsai.JSAI2025.0_3Win512 [**JSAI Annual Conference Award** 🏆].
- **A. Niwa** and H. Iso, “Addressing Ambiguity in Instruction for NLG,” in the *30th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2024)*, Hyogo, Japan, 2024 [**Young Researcher’s Encouragement Award** 🏆].
- **A. Niwa** and N. Okazaki, “Investigating the Effectiveness of Neighbor Distributions in the Pretrained Model T5,” in the *29th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2023)*, Okinawa, Japan, 2023.
- D. Taniguchi, K. Wakimoto, **A. Niwa**, and N. Okazaki, “Testing for Dependence on the Direction of Sentence Generation in Large Language Models,” in the *29th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2023)*, Okinawa, Japan, 2023.
- **A. Niwa**, S. Takase, and N. Okazaki, “Non-autoregressive Generation using the Nearest Neighbor,” in the *28th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2022)*, Online, 2022 [**Special Committee Award** 🏆].
- R. Ishikawa, **A. Niwa**, M. Sakae, and N. Okazaki, “Robust Dependency Parsing for the Omission of a Post-positional Particle using Pseudo Training Data,” in the *28th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2022)*, Online, 2022.
- **A. Niwa** and H. Matsuda, “A Study for Sentiment Analysis Accepting the Diverse of Emotion Sensitivities,” in *Proceedings of the 35th Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI2021)*, 2021. DOI: 10.11517/pjsai.JSAI2021.0_2Yin506.
- **A. Niwa**, K. Nishiguchi, and N. Okazaki, “Antonym Prediction in Context with BERT,” in the *27th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2021)*, Online, 2021.
- N. Nobori, T. Hiraoka, **A. Niwa**, K. Nishiguchi, and N. Okazaki, “Advertisement Slogan Generation Considering Company Information,” in the *27th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2021)*, Online, 2021.
- **A. Niwa**, K. Wakimoto, K. Nishiguchi, M. Mouri, and N. Okazaki, “Antithesis structure analysis in slogan using span candidate refinement with word correspondence,” in *Proceedings of the 34th Annual Conference of the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI2020)*, 2020. DOI: 10.11517/pjsai.JSAI2020.0_1E5GS901.
- **A. Niwa**, K. Nishiguchi, and N. Okazaki, “Slogan Generation with Antitheses Structure with Masked Language Models,” in the *15th Young Researcher Association for NLP Studies Symposium 2020 (YANS2020)*, Online, 2020.
- N. Nobori, T. Hiraoka, **A. Niwa**, N. Okazaki, K. Wakimoto, K. Kuroda, and K. Nishiguchi, “Advertisement Slogan Generation Considering company information,” in the *15th Young Researcher Association for NLP Studies Symposium 2020 (YANS2020)*, Online, 2020.
- **A. Niwa**, K. Wakimoto, K. Nishiguchi, M. Mouri, and N. Okazaki, “Analysis of Antitheses Structure in Advertisement Slogan,” in the *26th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2020)*, Ibaraki, Japan, 2020.
- **A. Niwa**, N. Okazaki, K. Nishiguchi, C. Kameyama, and M. Mouri, “A Study toward Automatic Advertisement Slogan Generation Considering Rhetorical Devices,” in the *14th Young Researcher Association for NLP Studies Symposium 2019 (YANS2019)*, Sapporo, Japan, 2019.
- —, “Analysis for Advertisement Slogan Generation,” in the *25th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing (NLP2019)*, Nagoya, Japan, 2019.

AWARDS AND HONORS

ACL 2026 Great Reviewer (133/8594)

📅 Jul. 2026

🌐 Website

NLP 2026 Committee Special Award (32/748)

📅 Mar. 2026

🌐 Website

JSAI 2025 Annual Conference Awards (one as first author, one as co-author) (16/513)

📅 Mar. 2025

NLP 2024 Young Researcher's Encouragement Award (18/427)

📅 Mar. 2024

🌐 Website

NLP 2022 Committee Special Award (16/365)

📅 Mar. 2022

🌐 Website

2021 Microsoft Research Asia Fellowship: Nomination Award (17/157)

📅 Nov. 2021

🌐 Website

COMMITTEE

SIG-NL Committee

📅 Apr. 2025 -

🌐 Website

Editorial Committee

📅 Apr. 2025 -

🌐 Website

JSAI Planning Committee

📅 May 2024 -

🌐 Website

INLG2024 Local Organizer

📅 2024

🌐 Website

NLP2024 Executive Committee

📅 2024

🌐 Website

NLP Colloquium

📅 June 2021 -

🌐 Website

NLP Study Group for Doctoral Students Organizer

📅 Dec. 2020 - Mar. 2023

🌐 Website

Young Researcher Association for NLP Studies (YANS) Committee

📅 Mar. 2020 - Mar. 2022

🌐 Website

INVITED TALKS

Language and AI: The World of NLP Research and Expanding Career Opportunities.

📅 Jun. 2026

📍 Lecture, Keio University

A Quick Overview to Unlock the Potential of LLMs through Prompt Engineering.

📅 Aug. 2024

📍 Advanced Natural Language Processing (NLP) by Tokyo AI

The Frontiers of Mathematics, Information, and AI

📅 Nov. 2022

📍 Online Seminar for middle and high-school female students by AIP RIKEN

Career Path as a Female Researcher

📅 Nov. 2021

📍 NeurIPS Meetup Japan 2021, Women in Machine Learning (WiML)

Derivation and Use of Templates in Natural Language Generation

📅 Nov. 2021

📍 Special Interest Group on Fundamental Problems in Artificial Intelligence (SIG-FPAI)

Trends in Natural Language Processing at NeurIPS 2019

📅 Mar. 2020

📍 The 78th AI Seminar: AI Trends and Top Conferences debriefing session (NeurIPS2019) by JSAI

A Smart Computer that Understands Language

📅 Nom. 2019

📍 Jissen Gakuen Senior High School, Tokyo

Natural Language Processing

📅 June 2019

📍 Denenchofu High School, Tokyo

SCHOLARSHIP, FELLOWSHIP, AND GRANTS-IN-AID

Research Fellowship for Young Scientists by Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS)

4,800,000 JPY / APPROX 45,000 USD

📅 Apr. 2021 — Mar. 2023

- The most prestigious fellowship for Ph.D. students in Japan [Acceptance Rate < 20%]

Grant-in-Aid for JSPS Fellows: Research Grant (Grant Number: 21J13602 [🔗](#))

1,500,000 JPY / APPROX 13,500 USD

📅 Apr. 2021 — Mar. 2023

NeurIPS 2019 Participation Support by the Japanese Society for Artificial Intelligence (JSAI) [🔗](#)

Full support of travel expense and registration fees

📅 Dec. 2019

Tsubame Scholarship for Doctoral Students by Tokyo Institute of Technology [🔗](#)

480,000 JPY / APPROX 4,300 USD

📅 Apr. 2020 — Mar. 2021